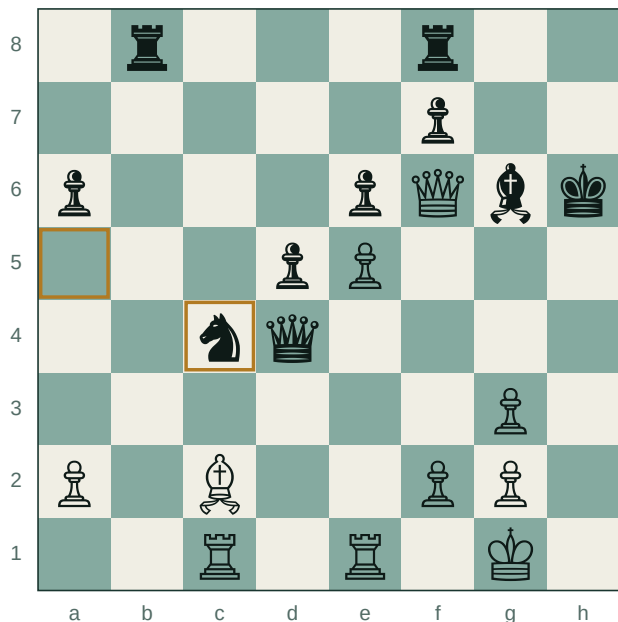


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 31

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 30...Nc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Kh2 Qg4 32. Rh1 Qh5+ 33. Kg1

31.Kh2 The king moves from g1 to h2. Recorded reply: **31...Qg4**.

32.Rh1 The rook moves from e1 to h1. Recorded reply: **32...Qh5+**.

33.Kg1 The king moves from h2 to g1. The changed line means the rook on h1 attacks the queen on h5.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on h6. Absolute pin: bishop on g6.